

# Tobias Treppmann

Product and design leader — AI shipped into production, in products where mistakes cost people money

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## PROFILE

I lead design teams and spent the last year building AI that ships rather than demos. At Bibel TV that's a support copilot in production and a fundraising system I built end to end. Before that, design leadership at Ninox and ChurchDesk, and five years at Datameer serving banks and insurers.

## EXPERIENCE

### Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

*Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany*

- AI support copilot, live in production. Assistive drafting for viewer letters, emails and social messages, following the handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases. Restricted topics are named in an explicit restricted-topic list in the system prompt. The draft is suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry, and every send decision stays human. Rolled out fully optional, on team-lead encouragement rather than mandate. Complex letters take minutes not hours, temp staff write in the company voice from day one, and skeptics converted after their hardest case.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end. Analysis, prompt architecture, prototype, then a production Claude skill. It generates follow-up content across in-app, web and video.
- Agentic engineering as design practice. My prototypes run on real APIs, and engineering ships from that code.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens with multi-platform sync. One commit reaches every platform, so consistency is structural rather than coordinated.
- Research at Bibel TV. Interviews recorded and transcribed in Teams, then analyzed with Claude.
- App redesign. Leading the iOS, Android and web redesign for engagement and retention, with engineering on the experimentation framework. Direction validated, moving into development.

### Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

*ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin*

- Booking built into the platform, not beside it. Inherited as a standalone add-on and delivered on the existing calendar and form builder, so the same build carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings. 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% acceptance at the launch customer, then shipped to every customer.
- The rest of the suite was designed and initiated, not shipped. Shared inbox and case management were scoped and specified. Only booking went live before the M&A centralization.
- Regulatory compliance shipped as product. An accessibility law landed on churches whose websites the platform hosts; what we shipped met it for them automatically, across six countries under GDPR plus church data-protection law.
- AI in the research loop — Claude to summarize customer feedback, and support tickets plus HubSpot mined for trends, sentiment, feature requests and pain points.
- Main customer-facing contact for the launch parish. Direct customer contact throughout, and the design bar on the platform was mine to set.

### Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

*Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany*

- Research at a scale a team cannot read — Dovetail as the shared insight repository, and Claude to analyze thousands of forum posts for sentiment and the pain points and feature requests underneath. Above a few hundred data points that analysis happens or it does not happen at all; below it, I read the responses, because nuance is the first thing a summariser drops.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead. Used a UX-maturity self-assessment to align the team with what the organization could actually support.
- Grew the team. Hired two. Coached the design lead through a hard cross-functional relationship. Owned the design system and set up joint governance with engineering.
- Redesigned how the team ran meetings. Pre-meeting prep, written agendas, structured turn-taking, decisions written down. An engineer who had been talked over became one of the strongest contributors, and the habits outlived the problem. Inclusion as a design problem, not a value statement.

### Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

*Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote*

- Service-to-product transformation. Partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog.
- Methodology transfer. Ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams. Primary stakeholder contact for the program.

### Director of Design

2016 – 2021

*Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC*

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years. Two UX designers reporting to me. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- Design system — I defined component behavior and specs across the library.
- Research inside regulated industries. Pioneered iterative [usertesting.com](https://usertesting.com) screening to reach personas working inside banks and insurers.
- Design as a business partner. Secured executive support for research and measurably increased UX maturity. Time-boxed strategic initiatives kept strategy and delivery in balance.

## EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership  
Kairos University, South Dakota, USA  
Completed 2026

Theological Studies  
Theologisches Seminar Rheinland  
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

AI in Production

Customer-support copilot live in production · AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end · Prompt-to-database interaction patterns · Human-in-the-loop by design: manually operated and embedded in nothing, so the send decision stays human · AI under GDPR-plus data-protection law · Agentic engineering with Claude Code on real APIs

Design Leadership

Senior Leadership Team member · 5 direct reports including a design lead · Performance calls in both directions · Coaching design leads through stakeholder conflict · Design-system ownership, with joint governance established with engineering · A UX-maturity self-assessment used to align a dissatisfied team with what the organization could actually support

Regulated and Consequential-Stakes Product

Top US / CA / UK banks and insurers · GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law across six countries · EU accessibility compliance shipped · Research methods that reach users inside regulated institutions

Design Systems and Cross-Platform

Design system as an API · DTCG tokens · Builds into Android, web and Figma; iOS and connected TV remain implementation tasks · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma Variables · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React

AI in the Research Process

Claude for customer-feedback summarization and for mining support tickets and HubSpot · Dovetail as a shared insight repository · Teams transcription into Claude analysis for interviews · The rule: AI analysis above a few hundred data points, where the alternative is not doing the work; direct reading below that, for the nuance a summariser drops

Research, Experimentation and Multi-Market

Iterative usertesting.com screening for hard-to-reach personas · A/B testing and experimentation infrastructure · Multi-country product across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH and DACH / UK / US · Cross-Atlantic delivery across a six-hour gap · German native, English C2